echoing Nietzsche, who wrote of the *Manu Smriti*: 'This absolutely Aryan testimony, a priestly codex of morality based on the Vedas, of a presentation of caste and of ancient provenance not pessimistic even though priestly—completes my conceptions of religion in the most remarkable manner.'[17] For Golwalkar, therefore, salvation lies not in Indian democracy, but in the historian Manu S. Pillai's words, 'in embracing Hindu dharmocracy'.[18]

Pillai's phrase is not entirely tongue-in-cheek: Golwakar intends traditional Hindu practices to prevail in his Hindu Rashtra, including caste discrimination. 'We know as a matter of history,' he writes, 'that our north-western and north-eastern areas, where the influence of Buddhism had disrupted the caste system, fell an easy prey to the onslaught of Muslims…. But the areas of Delhi and Uttar Pradesh, which were considered to be very orthodox and rigid in caste restrictions, remained predominantly Hindu even after remaining the very citadels of Muslim power and fanaticism.'[19] So the more caste-ridden society was, the more robustly it resisted the encroachments of the foreign faiths that sought to erode it: to Golwalkar, 'the so-called "caste-ridden" Hindu Society has remained undying and inconquerable…(while) casteless societies crumbled to dust'.[20]

The alternative to territorial nationalism, to Golwalkar, was a nationalism based on race. In *We, or Our Nationhood Defined*, at the height of Hitler's rise, Golwalkar wrote: 'To keep up the purity of the Race and its culture, Germany shocked the world by her purging the country of the Semitic Races—the Jews. Race pride at its highest has been manifested here. Germany has also shown how well nigh impossible it is for Races and cultures, having differences going to the root, to be assimilated into one united whole, a good lesson for us in Hindustan to learn and profit by.'[21]

This marked an evolution from Savarkar's notion that saw Hindutva as principally a cultural identity and Hinduism as a part of a national Hindu culture. In an important respect, Golwalkar reversed Savarkar's logic: 'With us,' he wrote, 'culture is but a product of our all-comprehensive religion, a part of its body and not distinguishable from it.'[22] From Golwalkar onwards, Hindutva was seen as an ideology seeking to